

Samuel Djommou Thengho

Cloud & DevOps Engineer

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PROFILE

Trained in systems integration, I automate software delivery from commit to alert. Nearly three years of responsibility for the availability and recoverability of SQL Server databases in production taught me to think in failure modes first. I built and ran a complete AWS environment with Terraform, ECS Fargate, Lambda and CloudWatch on my own; alongside it, a Kubernetes cluster from raw manifests through a custom Helm chart to GitOps deployment with ArgoCD. Certified STACKIT Cloud Engineer at Schwarz Digits. How I work: measure instead of assume, and make every change reproducible and reversible.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

DevOps and Cloud

CI/CD and GitOps — GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, GHCR, rulesets and blocking checks; ArgoCD with declarative Applications, automated sync, self-healing and prune

Orchestration — Kubernetes: declarative manifests, Deployments and StatefulSets, Services and Ingress, ConfigMaps and Secrets, PersistentVolumeClaims, readiness and liveness probes, resource limits, rolling updates and rollback

Packaging — Helm: custom charts, Go templating, per-environment values, release history and rollback

Containers — Docker, Docker Compose, ECS Fargate

Infrastructure as Code — Terraform: remote state, modules, controlled plan and apply runs

Configuration management — Ansible: reusable roles, Jinja2 templates, handlers, variable precedence, ansible-vault, check mode with diff

Observability — Prometheus with PromQL, service discovery and custom alerting rules; Grafana with provisioned datasources and dashboards; CloudWatch (metrics, alarms, logs), SNS

AWS — IAM, S3, Lambda, EventBridge, SSM Parameter Store, CloudWatch, ECS, VPC, ALB

Security — gitleaks, secret scanning, least privilege, encryption at rest and in transit

Development and Databases

Languages — JavaScript and TypeScript, SQL and T-SQL, Bash

Frameworks and databases — Node.js, Express, Next.js, PostgreSQL, Microsoft SQL Server

Quality assurance — Unit and integration tests, post-deployment smoke tests

Tools — Git, GitHub CLI, kubectl, kind, helm, actionlint, hadolint, ansible-lint, AWS CLI, psql

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Website relaunch and deployment automation

March 2026

Schmidszaunbau, freelance project, Hamburg | Bash, rsync over SSH, PHP, STRATO hosting

- Identified the docroot actually being served among four duplicated directories of an undocumented legacy infrastructure, by matching HTTP Last-Modified headers against file mtimes on the server. Documented the environment in a runbook.
- Replaced manual FTP deployment with a Bash pipeline over rsync and SSH: dry-run mode, configuration through environment variables, SSH key integration, timestamped backups before every production change.
- Automated verification after each go-live through curl smoke tests: checking the delivered content in German and English as well as the HTTP status of the API endpoint, with an unambiguous failure on regression.

Database Administrator, SQL Server

May 2023 – March 2026

GDE Solution GmbH, freelance, Eberdingen

- Backup and recovery: automated full, differential and transaction log backups, regularly tested restore procedures against defined RTO and RPO targets, high availability through AlwaysOn Availability Groups, Failover Cluster Instances and log shipping.
- Security and access: roles and permissions on a least-privilege basis, encryption at rest through TDE and in transit, compliance audits and detection of unauthorised access.
- Performance: analysis of CPU, memory, disk I/O, locks and deadlocks; tuning of slow T-SQL queries through indexing and statistics, preventive maintenance through index rebuilds and DBCC CHECKDB.
- Operations: instances on-premises and in the cloud, cumulative updates, version upgrades, migrations and capacity planning.

Arrival in Germany – language and further training

February 2022 – April 2023

German course at Anglo-German Institut, Stuttgart | Microsoft SQL Server Administration training, over 600 hours

DevOps Engineer, industrial plants and IoT

July 2021 – February 2022

High Tech Industry, Odessa, Ukraine

- Continuous delivery pipelines with GitLab CI and GitHub Actions, shipping code safely to local servers, IoT gateways and programmable logic controllers.

- Automatic alerting on loss of connectivity to a network gateway or on early signs of failure in an industrial control system.
- Infrastructure as Code with Terraform for the servers, databases and networks holding industrial reports and energy consumption history.
- Interface between development and plant: automation of software tests together with electrical engineers and PLC programmers, before physical installation into the control cabinets.

PERSONAL PROJECTS

MyMifa – job application tracker, running in production

February 2025 – present

Next.js, Express, PostgreSQL, Terraform, AWS

github.com/samueldel-mymifa

- CI/CD pipeline with six blocking checks: lint, unit tests, image build, schema rebuild, workflow and Terraform validation. No direct push to main.
- Infrastructure as Code with Terraform on AWS: encrypted and locked remote state in S3, IAM roles on a least-privilege basis, secrets isolated in SSM Parameter Store.
- Containerised deployment on ECS Fargate behind an ALB: VPC, subnets across two availability zones, security groups through cross-references. Ephemeral environment, built, validated, documented and torn down with Terraform.
- Diagnosed a faulty GitHub Actions cron by measurement and replaced it with EventBridge Scheduler and Lambda: 19 daily runs instead of the 96 configured, replacement chain live within 15 minutes.
- CloudWatch monitoring for two distinct failure modes: the function fails, and the function no longer runs at all. Three production bugs surfaced by tooling rather than by code review.

Kubernetes lab – from raw manifests through Helm to GitOps

March 2026 – present

Kubernetes with kind, Helm, Prometheus, Grafana, ArgoCD, Ansible, Linux

github.com/samueldel-k8s-lab | github.com/samueldel-ansible-lab

- Reusable Ansible role deploying nginx idempotently across a server group: Jinja2 templates driven by facts, handlers triggered only on actual change, loops and conditionals, deliberate control of variable precedence. Encrypted secrets with ansible-vault and non-interactive execution. Check mode with diff before every run; code passes ansible-lint at the production profile.
- Reproducible three-node cluster from a single kind configuration: Deployments and StatefulSets, coupling through labels and selectors, topology spread constraints, resource requests and limits, readiness and liveness probes, ConfigMaps and Secrets, dynamically provisioned persistent volumes. External access through ingress-nginx with path-based routing.
- The same application twice in the repository: as raw manifests and as a custom Helm chart. Templating with helpers, per-environment values, two parallel releases from one chart, checksum/config annotation triggering a rollout whenever the configuration changes.
- Prometheus deployed with Helm: service discovery, PromQL queries with aggregations and rate(), three custom alerting rules with a for duration. Grafana with a provisioned datasource and a dashboard loaded from files, including template variables — nothing configured through the UI, and restarting the pod loses nothing.
- GitOps with ArgoCD: Application declared as a manifest, automated sync with selfHeal and prune. A manual scaling that bypasses the repository is reverted within two minutes. Deploying means committing — no kubectl apply, no helm upgrade.
- Failure modes traced to their cause rather than worked around: ingress controller scheduled on the wrong node, double-counted container metrics without the container!= filter in cAdvisor, client-side versus server-side apply conflict on an oversized CRD.

CERTIFICATIONS AND TRAINING

Certified STACKIT Cloud Engineer — STACKIT University, Schwarz Digits, Neckarsulm, March 2026. Further modules: STACKIT Product Fundamentals, DevOps Fundamentals, Terraform Fundamentals, Cloud Foundry Fundamentals, Deploying an Application with STACKIT Kubernetes Engine, Kubernetes Fundamentals, Docker Fundamentals, Linux Fundamentals.

AI Fluency: Framework and Foundations — Anthropic, in partnership with University College Cork, 2026.

Microsoft SQL Server Administration — KiawiTechIT Academy, over 600 hours, October 2022 to January 2023.

German language certificate, level B1 — Anglo-German Institut, Stuttgart, June to November 2022.

EDUCATION

Bachelor in Banking and Finance — University of Dschang, Cameroon, 2020.

IT Specialist in Systems Integration (Fachinformatiker Systemintegration) — Collège de la Salle, Douala, Cameroon, 2019.

LANGUAGES

French: native. German: B1 certificate 2022, current level B2. English: fluent.